

10 out of 10 life upgrades for men that cost \$100 or less

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Sep 24, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/jLT8HRye9co> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter runs through ten affordable purchases — each \$100 or less — covering nutrition tracking, movement, supplementation, sleep, productivity, and appearance to systematically upgrade a man's life.

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Upgrade 1: Food Scale 0:00

- Purpose: track your macros accurately
 - Framed bluntly as the tool to "finally stop being a fat boy"
- Knowing exact portion weights removes guesswork from calorie and macro counting

Upgrade 2: Walking Shoes 0:05

- Goal: reach 10,000–20,000 steps per day
- A quality, comfortable pair lowers the friction to getting daily low-intensity cardio

Upgrade 3: Meal Prep Delivery Service 0:08

- Delivers healthy, pre-made food on a weekly basis
- Acknowledged to cost more than \$100 upfront, but framed as net-positive financially

- Savings come from reduced grocery spending AND time saved on:
 - Trips to the grocery store
 - Cooking meals
 - Doing dishes
- Net result: saves more money (and time) than it costs

Upgrade 4: Creatine Monohydrate 0:22

- Recommendation: take it every single day
- Benefits extend beyond the gym:
 - Good for brain health
 - Good for mental health
- Universally recommended — "everybody should be taking creatine"

Upgrade 5: Large Water Bottle 0:30

- A oversized bottle eliminates the need to consciously track water intake throughout the day
- Target: easily hit over **one gallon** of water per day
 - Brandon personally drinks two gallons per day

Upgrade 6: Blackout Curtains 0:44

- Purpose: improve sleep quality by blocking outside light
- Rationale: you cannot hustle, grind, or perform at a high level if you are tired
 - Sleep is positioned as a foundational productivity input

Upgrade 7: Cheap Notebook 0:52

- Keep it on your person at all times
- Use cases:
 - Writing down ideas as they occur
 - Capturing everything you need to remember
- Low cost, high leverage habit tool

Upgrade 8: ChatGPT Pro Subscription 0:57

- Referred to as "Chad GBT Pro" in the transcript
- Core value: automate grunt work and save significant time in daily life

Upgrade 9: Fitted Black T-Shirts 1:03

- Recommendation: buy a pack of them
- Preferred style: **V-neck**
- Fitted cut implies a sharper, more put-together appearance at minimal cost



Upgrade 10: Fitbit Air 1:07

- Tracks two key metrics:
 - Calories burned
 - Sleep data
- Positioned as the best budget alternative if you cannot afford:
 - A **Whoop** band
 - An **Oura Ring**
- Framed as the accessible entry point into biometric self-tracking